Activity 1 Guide - Plan and Inspect a Café Product Shoot

Scenario: A neighbourhood café needs eight smartphone photographs of a signature dish and wellness product for a launch post.

Tools: Smartphone, microfibre cloth, tabletop tripod, LED panel, reflector, power bank

Deliverable: Approved shot plan, equipment inspection, safety check and two test frames

Detailed step-by-step

1. Read the client brief and underline audience, message, channel and due time.
2. Write a shot objective and define the production style in three adjectives.
3. Create an eight-frame shot list covering wide, medium, close and detail views.
4. Assign composition, angle, orientation and light direction to each frame.
5. Check location rules, food handling boundaries, permissions and trip hazards.
6. Clean the active lens; verify battery, storage, file format and resolution.
7. Inspect the clamp, tripod locks, LED power and cable placement; record defects.
8. Place equipment without blocking staff or customers and take two test frames.
9. Review sharpness, reflections, highlights, colour and distracting background items.
10. Obtain peer/client approval of the shot plan before full capture.

Acceptance criteria

[ ] All eight shots map to a clear purpose

[ ] Inspection checklist is complete

[ ] No unsafe equipment remains in use

[ ] Test frames meet focus and highlight criteria

Troubleshooting

- Missing control: use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- Soft result: clean, stabilise, re-focus and repeat.
- Clipped highlight: lower exposure or change the light/camera position.
- Unsafe/unauthorised capture: stop and use a controlled substitute.